



PEAK PEEK:
(left) Visitors
at the Art
Summit and
(below) the
culture min-
ister, organ-
isers, artists
and experts
in the field
of art at the
inauguration

ART OF THE MATTER

The country's first-ever art summit kicked off on the right note, even as it provided for a reality check on the state of Indian art

■ By Nirmala Ravindran

Number crunching was everyone's favourite game at the India Art Summit in Delhi and why not, for this was one industry that had broken free of its cottage industry status. From galleries that spoke about Indian art growing at an annual rate of 35 per cent a year (current estimate: Rs 1,500 crore), to prices that Indian art is fetching globally, numbers ruled the conversations and the forum proceedings. What was evident at the end of the summit was the success story of Indian art, not thanks to, but despite the infrastructural support in India. With hardly any government inputs or support, the art world in India has, in a way, broken free of its shackles to hold its own in the world of art globally.

Art fairs across the world are, in essence, trade fairs, that bring together buyers, sellers and other representatives from supporting businesses of art, each catering to specific aspects of the art industry including,

